[Metric]
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Superseding
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November 27, 1979

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
MARKER, TUBE TYPE
(WHITE)

This Commercial Item Description is approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration for use by all federal agencies.

1. Scope. This Commercial Item Description covers tube type valve action felt tip markers with white ink used in freehand marking, writing, drawing, and identification markings on various types of materials and surfaces.

2. Salient Characteristics.

2.1 The marker shall be constructed so as to prevent evaporation and leakage of the ink and shall be equipped with a protective cap.

2.2 The marker shall contain a minimum of 5.9 cm3 (.2 fl ozs) of permanent, quick drying, white, pigment type.

2.3 Metal or plastic used shall be of a material appropriate for the intended purpose and when used externally shall be suitable for coating. The writing tip shall be bullet shaped and either fine 1.2mm ± 0.12mm or medium 1.8mm ± 0.18mm.

2.4 The ink shall be fed to the tip by valve action and shall produce solid white lines, free of skips, on glossy, non-porous surface such as film, negatives, photographs, glass, plastics, painted surfaces, and metal.

2.5 Shelf Life. The items shall be able to meet all the requirements of this specification from the time of delivery to a minimum of 18 months under normal storage conditions. Suppliers shall replace, without cost to the government, all markers failing to meet this requirement.

2.7 Workmanship. The marker shall be free from defects or imperfections of manufacture which may affect their durability, appearance or serviceability or present a hazard to the user.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7520

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3. Regulatory Requirements:

The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

4. Quality Assurance Requirements:

4.1 Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and therefore as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.2 Examination and Testing.

4.2.1 Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. (Statistical Process Control) SPC Techniques) as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. If used, objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document or, herein.

4.2.2 End item inspection / testing may be used by the offeror or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in process quality controls. In process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing.

4.2.3 For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection / test shall be required. The sample unit shall be one marker. Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI) / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

4.2.4 An inspection lot shall consist of all like items submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level for visual and dimensional testing shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The inspection level for performance testing shall be S-1 with an AQL of 6.5 percent defective. The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan as indicated above.

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5. Performance Tests: Unless otherwise specified, the tests shall be conducted in an atmosphere of 21° ± 3°C (64.5°-75.2°F) and a relative humidity of 50% ± 5%. Tests involving writing, shall be conducted with the markers held at an angle approximately 55° ± 5° from the horizontal and with a writing pressure so that the markings are clearly visible. The write-out speed shall be set at 35 ± 5 feet per minute, and the spring generated point shall be stopped, the marker capped, and allowed to recover nib down for 15 minutes. The initial point load shall be increased by 10 grams after each cycle. The write-out test shall continue until the marker has reached the minimum write-out distance. Test paper shall be in accordance with A-A-2804A, type III white bond paper having a pH of 5.0 with a basis weight of 60 grams per square meter (16 pound, 17 x 22 - 500). A tolerance of 5% is allowable. Paper for the Machine Writing Test shall have an additional requirement of 160 - 140 seconds maximum smoothness on both sides using the Sheffield method per the most current TAPPI T538 test method. Alternately, paper conforming to JCP-O-60 can be used as an alternate source.

5.1 Drying Time. Place a sheet of paper on a smooth, flat surface and partially cover with a second sheet of paper. Place a 200 gram weight, approximately 31.75 mm(1.25 inches) in diameter, on top of the second sheet. Write a five-letter word on the exposed portion of the bottom sheet, allow to dry three seconds, and immediately draw the top sheet and the weight across the writing at a rate of approximately 101.6 mm (4.0 inches) per second. The writing shall not smear or smudge.

5.2 Startability. Write a five-letter word with an unused sample marker. Then place marker on its side with cap off for three hours. Immediately draw the marker nib across a sheet of paper at a rate of 101.6 mm (4.0 inches) per second, increments of 203.32 mm (8 inches) until a solid continuous mark of at lease .38 mm (0.015 inches) width is attained. Then place marker horizontally with cap off for an additional 15 hours and recap for 30 minutes. Remove the cap and draw the marker nib across the paper as described above and examine.

5.3 Machine Write Test. The machine tests shall be conducted on a Anja model W-10B, Hartley model W10-F , K&L, or Minitek marker test machines or equivalent with the following parameters set:

Writing Load:	0.490 N (50gF)
Writing Angle:	55 degrees (continuously varying)
Writing Speed:	3352.8 mm (11 feet) per minute
Writing Pattern:	Circle

Select the marker tested and mount in writing position on the machine. Set the machine speed at 3352.8mm per minute and the writing pressure at 50 grams. Operate the apparatus, stopping for a 15 minute recuperation period after each successive 91440.3mm of writing. Continue until the distance requirement is met or the marker fails to produce a solid continuous line 0.38 mm (0.015 inches) to 1.27 mm (0.050 inches) wide.

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6. Packaging:

6.1 Preservation, packing, and marking shall be specified in the contract or order.

7. Notes:

7.1 Applicable Documents. Issues of the following documents, in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

7.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

7.1.2 Application for copies of (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 and (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 may be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control. PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

7.1 4 Ordering Information. Purchaser should select the required options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents.

A. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
B. Purchasers shall specify type of tube marker and size of tip.
C. Purchasers shall specify arrangement for inspection and inspection facilities, if other than specified.
D. Purchasers shall specify packaging, packing, and any special marking for shipment, if other than required.
E. Purchasers shall specify identification marking, if other than required.
F. Purchasers shall specify if bar code marking is not required.
G. Purchasers shall specify palletization, if required.

7.2 National Stock Number Listing.

Marker, Tube-Type

7520-00-558-1487

MILITARY INTERESTS:
NONE: DoD has determined that no military activity has an interest in this commercial item description.

PREPARING ACTIVITY
GSA-FSS

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